Japan Portfolio Brief — Thursday, November 12, 2026

This brief covers the Wed Nov 11 US session and the Thu Nov 12 Tokyo and Seoul sessions, both closed.

Data-quality warning (continuing): all research came from search-result summaries. WebFetch could not reach kabutan, nikkei.com, Sedaily, investing.com, smtg.jp or japex.co.jp from this environment, so no primary filing was opened. Figures are press- or aggregator-reported. "QUIET" means nothing was found, not that the name is confirmed quiet. Check TDnet or DART before acting on any single-name call.

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1. Top of the stack

1. Nvidia leadership turmoil hit Asian chip and AI names. SoftBank fell 3%, and NAVER fell about 6% on a profit miss.

- **Trigger.** After the Nov 11 US close, reports said Nvidia's board was weighing the removal of CEO Jensen Huang. These reports are unconfirmed; the board's own Nov 8 statement backed him (Yahoo live, Nvidia IR). Before that, the US session was strong: S&P 500 about +1.3%, Nasdaq +1.6% (TheStreet).
- **Tokyo.** The Nikkei fell 0.70% to 60,819.36, its first drop in four days, dragged by Advantest and Recruit. TOPIX rose 0.20% to 3,937.33, and 27 of 33 sectors were up, so the selling was concentrated (Investing.com, Zaikei).
- **SoftBank (9984).** Closed ¥3,738 (-¥117, about -3.0%) after trading up in the morning (Zaikei contribution table). That implies a Nov 11 close of ¥3,855, which **confirms yesterday's unverified figure**. No CDS print newer than the Nov 6 level of 466bp was found, and no rating action (GuruFocus).
- **NAVER (035420).** Q3 came out Nov 12, not Nov 11 (ZDNet Korea, Sedaily):
  - revenue ₩3.47tn (+10.7%, a record), about 1% below consensus;
  - operating profit ₩451.3bn (-20.9%), about 9% below the ₩497.6bn consensus;
  - net profit ₩402.5bn (-45.2%).

  The stock fell about 5.7–5.9% to about ₩183,200; one source says -3.8% (Investing.com transcript). Positive: about ₩2tn of AI-compute contracts, with revenue starting in H1 2027.
- **Korea.** KOSPI fell 0.61% to 5,342.73 and KOSDAQ fell 1.22% to 696.53. Foreigners were still net buyers of KOSPI, at about ₩370bn (JoongAng, Sedaily).
- **Verdict: MATTERS.** This is a single-name governance shock, not a macro break. Nvidia reports Nov 17.

2. The yen touched 159.94 and officials are jawboning. BoJ's Asada leaned dovish, but PPI ran hot. This bears on the JGB 466 reinvestment.

- **Yen.** USD/JPY hit 159.94, a two-month high (mlq.ai). Vice Finance Minister Mimura called the moves "too rapid" (investingLive). SocGen flags intervention risk near 160 (FXStreet). No intervention has been reported.

- **Asada (Nagasaki, Nov 12):**
  - the policy rate is already inside staff's 1.1–2.5% estimate of neutral, so further hikes carry more risk;
  - the BoJ must be mindful of the effects of past hikes;
  - consumption is weak.

  He dissented on the June and September hikes. Sources disagree on whether he hinted at a December dissent (FXStreet, ActionForex).
- **But:** October PPI was +7.1% y/y, against 6.5% expected. A Reuters poll still expects a December hike to 1.50% (Reuters via AOL). December hike odds are about 75–83% by swaps and futures, with unclear timestamps (itiger).
- **JGBs.**
  - The 10y is about 2.80% (TradingEconomics).
  - The 5y auction was firm: bid-to-cover 3.67 per Bloomberg (prior 3.56, 12-month average 3.4) and a 0.02 tail. FXStreet reports 3.97x and an average yield of 2.186%, so the bid-to-cover conflicts.
- **Verdict: MATTERS.** See section 4 for the JGB decision.

3. Bank results week: SMTG raised its full-year net forecast to a record ¥420bn and Kita-Nippon beat. MUFG and five more report tomorrow.

- **SMTG (8309):**
  - full-year net profit forecast raised to ¥420bn from ¥380bn (+32% y/y, a record);
  - dividend raised to ¥51 from ¥47.5 (Kabutan).

  A **¥50bn buyback is UNVERIFIED** (a forum post only); check TDnet. The stock reacts on Nov 13.
- **Kita-Nippon (8551):** H1 ordinary profit ¥3.62bn (+17.4%), 54.9% of the ¥6.6bn plan, in line with history; Jul–Sep -30% (Kabutan). Coverage follows this ticker, but see the owner question in section 4.
- **Nov 13:** MUFG, Japan Post, Kyoto FG, Shimizu, Fidea, North Pacific (8524) and Yakult.

4. First-day reactions to results: Tigers Polymer limit-up, Mitsubishi Materials about +6%. JAPEX raised guidance, and Sanken's loss is confirmed.

- **Tigers Polymer (4231)** closed ¥1,113 (+¥150, +15.6%), a limit-up move, after its guidance and dividend raise (f-frontier, Kabutan).
- **Mitsubishi Materials (5711)** was about +6.2–6.7% (¥4,390–4,408), up from ¥4,132. The official close is not verified (Kabutan, Yahoo). Guidance: operating profit raised to ¥165bn, ordinary to ¥220bn and net to ¥160bn (Nikkei).
- **JAPEX (1662):** H1 ordinary profit ¥33.6bn (+2.2%); full year raised 15% to ¥53.0bn (Kabutan). No buyback found.
- **Sanken (6707):**
  - H1 operating loss of ¥2.56bn confirmed, worse than the ¥2.4bn loss guide; Jul–Sep swung to a loss;
  - full-year sales cut to ¥82.0bn from ¥86.5bn, operating profit target held at ¥1.4bn (Kabutan).

  The Nov 12 share move was not found.

5. Korea holdco Q3s are starting. LG Corp operating profit fell 22% on LG Chem, and LG Chem's buyback size is resolved.

- **LG Corp (003550):** Q3 consolidated operating profit ₩327.7bn (-21.8%). Equity-method income roughly halved to ₩107.7bn, mainly because of LG Chem (Newspim, eToday). Standalone operating profit rose 23.5%.
- **LG Chem pref (051915): resolved.**
  - A **₩300bn** buyback trust, all to be cancelled. It covers common and preferred shares and runs Dec 1, 2026 to May 31, 2027.
  - About ₩100bn more goes to the FY26 dividend, giving ₩400bn of total return (Econovill).
- **F&F (383220)** reported Nov 10, just before the window: operating profit ₩108.4bn (-15.3%) and a ₩59bn treasury-share cancellation (Newspim).

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2. What matters, by theme

Macro thread (week in context)

- **US.**
  - The Nov 11 equity session was strong, but bond markets were closed for Veterans Day (INDmoney).
  - UST 10y about 4.98–4.99%, having briefly broken 5% on Nov 10 (CNN).
  - December Fed hike odds are about 87–91% for 25bp. Waller is open to 50bp (FXStreet).
- **BoJ.**
  - **Rate:** 1.25%; next meeting Dec 17–18.
  - **This week's signals pull both ways:** Asada was dovish, while PPI was hot and the yen is near 160 (see Top 2).
  - **Upcoming speakers:** Takata on Nov 16 at 13:00 in Tokushima. He proposed 1.5% in October, so expect a hawkish lean (BoJ calendar). Tamura's Nov 26 speech is unverified this run.
- **JGBs.**
  - **Nov 12:** 10y about 2.80%. The Nov 11 close was 2.795% (10y) and about 3.94% (30y) (Finimize).
  - **Not found:** Nov 12 prints for the 2y, 5y, 20y and 30y; the 30y auction tail (Nov 10); the 5y auction size (prior ¥1.9tn) (Newsquawk).
  - **Context:** still below the Sep 2 peaks of 10y 3.02% and 30y 4.18%.
- **Yen.** See Top 2. Finance Minister Katayama has said the US–Japan FX statement is "alive" and warned against disorderly moves; the quote may predate Nov 12 (investingLive).
- **Japan data.**
  - Q3 GDP (first estimate) **Nov 16 at 08:50**, consensus about +0.3–0.4% annualized (ESRI, nippon.com).
  - October national CPI **Nov 20** (Stat Bureau).
- **Korea.**
  - **BoK:** decision Nov 26 at a 3.00% base rate; a hike to 3.25% is widely expected (18 of 20 in a Sedaily poll) (fnnews).

- **Won:** USD/KRW 1,330.7, single source (MoneyToday).
- **Market structure:**
  - The FSS denied reports of a meeting on a KOSDAQ tiering system; those reports had fuelled KOSDAQ's +5.6% on Nov 11.
  - Treasury-share cancellations totalled ₩90.9tn in Jan–Sep. Korea ranked 5th in ACGA's governance ranking (Sedaily).
  - No new Commercial Act or short-selling action.

Megacaps / tech

- **SoftBank (9984):** see Top 1.
  - **ABB Robotics ($5.4bn):** China blocked the China portion. ABB says talks continue, and no carve-out or termination has been announced (SCMP).
  - **OpenAI:** gains from OpenAI's new funding round are not yet booked. Sources disagree on cumulative investment ($54.6bn vs $64.6bn) (CNBC).
- **NAVER (035420):** see Top 1.
- **Sanken (6707):** see Top 4. **MATTERS, negative.**
- **Canon (7751): QUIET.** ¥4,791 (+2.15%) (Nikkei).
- **Sony (6758): QUIET.** Up on the day (Kabutan); the full-year operating profit guide is ¥1.87tn after the Nov 5 raise.
- **Omron (6645): QUIET.** About ¥4,950 (+0.3%) intraday, after the post-results selloff (Yahoo).
- **Keyence (6861): QUIET.** No news; the Nov 12 move is unverified.
- **Daikin (6367): QUIET.** A Daikin Applied institute groundbreaking on Nov 11 (Daikin).
- **Seiko Epson (6724): QUIET.** A buyback-related notice on Nov 9 (Epson).
- **SHIFT (3697): QUIET.** No catalyst in the next two weeks (minkabu).
- **MegaChips (6875): QUIET. Figures reconciled.** H1 operating profit was ¥0.92bn (-10.6%), ordinary profit ¥1.54bn (2.2x) and net profit about ¥33.7bn. Net profit was lifted by a ¥48.4bn gain on SiTime shares. The year-end dividend is ¥300 (gamebiz). The two figures that conflicted yesterday measure different profit lines.
- **Results due:**
  - **Nov 13:**
    - Appier (4180): full-year revenue guide ¥54.0bn (kabuyoho).
    - Optex (6914), 15:30: consensus ordinary profit ¥11.3bn vs a ¥10.8bn guide (IFIS).
    - Universal Entertainment (6425): H1 ordinary profit was already 142% of the full-year guide, so a raise is possible (IFIS).
  - **Nov 16:** Oro (3983).
  - *About Nov 16:** RS Technologies (3445) (Investing.com).

Banks / financials

- **SMTG, Kita-Nippon:** see Top 3.
- **MUFG (8306):** results Nov 13. It closed ¥3,502 on Nov 11; the Nov 12 close was not found. Q1 net profit was a record ¥809.4bn (Nikkei). The investor briefing is Nov 17.
- **Resona (8308): NOISE, follow-through.**
  - **Guidance:** the full-year net target of ¥340bn stands.

    - **M&A Capital Partners:** Resona is acquiring about 1.59m MACP shares (5%) from MACP management. This is not a Resona buyback (Nikkei).
    - **Settlement:** Nov 13.
- **North Pacific / Hokuyo (8524):** H1 Nov 13, time unconfirmed (14:00 last year). H1 and full-year guidance were raised on Oct 28 (Kabutan).
- **Japan Post (6178):** H1 **Nov 13** per Yahoo, Kabutan and kabuyoho (Yahoo).
- **Kyoto FG (5844), Shimizu (8364), Fidea (8713):** H1 Nov 13. QUIET.
- **SBI (8473): NOISE.** About ¥2,933.5 (+1.7%) late in the session (Nikkei).
- **Mitsui Fudosan (8801): QUIET.** ¥1,548 on Nov 11, after the Nov 6 drop. A ¥20bn buyback runs to Oct 2027 (minkabu).
- **TOC (8841): QUIET today.** H1 beat on Nov 10; the full-year ¥4.6bn plan looks conservative (Kabutan).
- **Katakura (3001): unexplained rally, flag.**
    - **Price:** all-time high of ¥4,130 on Nov 5, up about 78% from the June low (Matsui).
    - **Known holders:** Zennor Asset Management (5.04%, May) and ASO Group (about 11%) (Kabutan).
    - **No trigger found:** no tender offer or new large-holder filing was found for October–November.
    - **Next:** Q3 results Nov 16.
- **Yakult (2267):** H1 Nov 13; full-year guide is operating profit ¥44.0bn (kabuyoho). QUIET.

Industrials / autos / materials

- **Honda (7267): MATTERS.**
    - **Price:** fell about 4.5% to ¥1,769 on Nov 11, because the guidance raise came in under the QUICK consensus. It rebounded 2.4% to ¥1,811.5 on Nov 12 (Kabutan, Nikkei quote).
    - **EV loss:** ¥435.1bn (H1) vs ¥484.8bn is still not reconciled; it may be a scope difference. The full-year EV loss guide is ¥520bn.
- **Mitsubishi Materials (5711):** see Top 4.
    - **Records:** H1 net profit of ¥120.8bn is a record.
    - **Dividend:** shows ¥116 with "no revision" (unverified against the tanshin).
    - **Caveat:** the benefit from low-cost tungsten inventory fades from Q4 (tousaiblog).
- **Sumitomo Metal Mining (5713): MATTERS, negative.**
    - **Nov 11:** fell as low as ¥6,948, then recovered to close at ¥7,452 (-0.6%) (Zaikei). The Nov 12 close was not found.
    - **Gold:** touched a one-week low of about $3,978 (Sina).
    - **Impairment:** sources give ¥41.6bn and ¥42.55bn (SMM slides).
- **Kubota (6326): NOISE, negative drift.** ¥2,500 (-1.2%), down 8.3% since Nov 5, after the Q3 miss on tariff refunds (Yahoo).
- **Suzuki (7269): QUIET.** About ¥2,195 (+0.3%) (Nikkei).
- **Subaru (7270): QUIET.** The full-year guide of ¥150bn is held after the Nov 10 H1.
- **JAPEX (1662):** see Top 4. **MATTERS, positive.** The stock went in near its year low (¥1,439 on Nov 6) (Matsui).

- **JR Central (9022), Keisei (9009): QUIET.**
- **Shochiku (9601): QUIET.** ¥11,790 on Nov 11 (Yahoo).
- **Tokyotokeiba (9672):** Q3 **Nov 13**. Q3 cumulative consensus is ¥12.16bn ordinary profit, against ¥11.81bn a year earlier (kabuyoho).

Japan small / mid caps

- **Tigers Polymer (4231):** see Top 4. **MATTERS, positive.** Caveat: implied H2 ordinary profit is down 2.5%, so the raise mostly reflects the H1 beat (TDnet).
- **Obara (6877): date now set.** Full-year (September year-end) results **Nov 13 at about 17:00** (traders). The company guide is ¥11.8bn ordinary profit (a record) against a ¥12.7bn consensus, and nine-month profit was 82% of plan (IFIS).
- **Shibaura Machine (6104): mixed.** H1 beat its own guide, but only 28% of the full-year plan is done (Kabutan). The Nov 12 move was not found.
- **Hi-Lex (7279): QUIET.** Full-year results **Dec 11*** per Traders Web (traders). The nine-month figure is already above the full-year plan.
- **KH Neochem (4189): QUIET.**
  - The buyback (10.52% / ¥12bn) runs to Oct 2027. 1.993m treasury shares are to be cancelled on Dec 11 (Kabutan).
  - No progress report yet; the first is expected in early December.
- **Valqua (7995), Fudo Tetra (1813), Ebara Jitsugyo (6328), Nakayama Steel (5408): QUIET in the window.** Results came out Nov 4–9; see yesterday's brief.
  - Fudo Tetra: at 60% of its full-year plan versus a 37% norm, it has room to raise (Kabutan).

Korea names

- **NAVER, LG Corp, LG Chem pref, F&F:** see Top 1 and Top 5.
- **Taekwang (003240): WATCH.**
  - **Audit committee deadline:** the 30-day window for a reply to Truston's Oct 13 demand runs out around Nov 12. No reply was found (MTN).
  - **Q3:** due by Nov 16.
  - **Beware:** "Taekwang Q3 net loss" headlines refer to 태광 (023160), a different company.
- **SK Inc (034730): QUIET.** Q3 possibly **Nov 16 at 16:00*** (knowingasset).
- **SK Discovery (006120): QUIET.** Its own Q3 is due about Nov 14. Subsidiaries have reported: SK Chemicals' operating profit was ₩33.6bn (+116%) (Newspim) and SK Gas's ₩147.7bn (-14.9%).
- **LS Corp (006260): QUIET.** Q3 is due Nov 13–14. Beware stale 2025 "₩257.1bn" headlines.
- **Samsung C&T (028260): QUIET.** About +0.5% in the morning (anewsa). Its 2026 cancellation of about ₩2tn of treasury shares is ongoing (CEO Score).
- **Misto (081660): QUIET.** Q3 is due by Nov 16. Q3 dividend ₩960 (MT).
- **Hyosung (004800), Amorepacific Group (002790), LG Electronics pref (066575): QUIET.** Q3 came out in late October.
- **Q3 due by about Nov 14–16; nothing found (QUIET):**
  - ILJIN Holdings (015860)
  - Eusu (000700)
  - Ubiquoss (078070)

- Daewon Sanup (005710)
- Motonic (009680)
- Seoul City Gas (017390)
- Samyang Tongsang (002170)

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3. Probably noise

- **Investing.com "SoftBank stock jumps 14%" transcript headline:** contradicts every price source.
- **Fisco snippet "Sanken -1.9%":** unclear whether it refers to Sanken. A 2025 article about a -10.5% drop also appears in searches; it is stale.
- **"Taekwang Q3 net loss":** a different company (023160).
- **"LS Q3 OP ₩257.1bn" and "Misto Q3 OP ₩131.9bn":** 2025 figures.
- **"LG Chem ₩30bn buyback":** a typo for ₩300bn.
- **Nikkei -0.71% (Investing.com) vs -0.70%:** rounding.
- **Kabutan listing SoftBank as both a drag and a gainer:** intraday snapshots; the Zaikei closing table is used.
- **KOSDAQ tiering-system rumours:** the FSS denied the meeting; rumour-driven.

4. Time-sensitive / positions watch

JGB No. 466 (0.50%, JP1024661QB1): matured Sun Nov 1; settlement is still unverified, 11 days on.

- **Still unconfirmed:** no source confirms the ISIN or the payment date (presumed Mon Nov 2). The terms were confirmed on MOF pages in earlier runs: a 2-year note issued 2024-11-01 and maturing 2026-11-01 (MOF).
- **Decisions:**
  1. Get the custodian to confirm redemption.
  2. Make the overdue reinvestment decision. The case for reinvesting short has improved:
     - the 5y auction drew firm demand, at an average yield of about 2.19% (single source);
     - the 10y is about 2.80%;
     - December BoJ hike odds are about 75–83%, and hot PPI supports a hike.

     Against that, Asada's dovish view and possible yen intervention (which would tend to rally JGBs) argue against waiting much longer. Key dates before the Dec 17–18 BoJ meeting: GDP Nov 16, CPI Nov 20, Takata's speech Nov 16.
  3. Update `watchlist-japan.md` once redemption is confirmed. **The position stays on the watchlist and is flagged, not dropped.**

Open identity question for owner: 8551 vs 8524.

- **No change in the identities:** 8524 = 北洋銀行 (North Pacific Bank, Sapporo); 8551 = 北日本銀行 (Kita-Nippon Bank, Morioka), per Kabutan and kabuyoho titles.
- **Coverage still follows the 8551 ticker.** Kita-Nippon reported today; North Pacific reports tomorrow. Please confirm which bank is held.

Watchlist updates made this run (no identity changes):

- SoftBank's Nov 11 close is confirmed.
- The LG Chem buyback size is resolved at ₩300bn.
- Obara's results date is set as Nov 13.
- Hi-Lex's results date is Dec 11*.
- Sanken's H1 loss is confirmed.

Portfolio-level:

- Nvidia governance headlines are the near-term risk for SoftBank, NAVER and the semi-adjacent names (RS Technologies, MegaChips, Sanken).
- USD/JPY at 160 is the intervention line; intervention would move the exporters (Honda, Subaru, Suzuki, Canon).
- Bank-results day tomorrow is the biggest single-day catalyst for the portfolio.

*Calendar (= aggregator/inferred/unconfirmed):**

- **Nov 13:**
  - MUFG
  - Japan Post
  - Kyoto FG, Shimizu, Fidea
  - North Pacific (8524)
  - Yakult
  - Optex (15:30)
  - Appier
  - Universal Entertainment
  - Tokyotokeiba
  - Obara full-year (about 17:00)
  - LS Corp Q3*
  - Settlement of Resona's MACP stake
  - SMTG first trading reaction
- **Nov 14:** Korea Q3 filings (SK Discovery, ILJIN, Eusu, Ubiquoss, the small caps)*
- **Nov 16:**
  - Japan Q3 GDP (08:50)
  - BoJ Takata speech (13:00)
  - Oro Q3
  - Katakura Q3
  - RS Technologies Q3*
  - SK Inc Q3 (16:00)*
  - Korea Q3 deadline (Taekwang, Misto)
- **Nov 17:**
  - Nvidia Q3
  - MUFG investor briefing
- **Nov 18:** SMTG investor briefing

- **Nov 20:** Japan October CPI
- **Nov 24:** BoJ core CPI measures
- **Nov 26:**
  - Bank of Korea decision (hike expected)
  - BoJ Tamura speech*
- **Nov 27:** start of the LGES PRS disposal (LG Chem; runs to Dec 24)
- **Dec 1:** LG Chem buyback trust begins
- **Dec 11:**
  - KH Neochem treasury-share cancellation
  - Hi-Lex full-year results*
- **Dec 17–18:** BoJ meeting

5. Follow-up questions to investigate

- **SMTG:** is there a ¥50bn buyback (TDnet)? What is H1 net profit? How does the stock react on Nov 13?
- **JGB 466:** has the custodian confirmed redemption, and what is the reinvestment instruction? What was the 5y auction size, and was bid-to-cover 3.67 or 3.97?
- **8551 vs 8524:** which bank is actually held?
- **SoftBank:** is there a CDS print after Nov 6? Is anything moving on the ABB carve-out? How exposed is it to the Nvidia governance story?
- **NAVER:** how quickly does the ₩2tn of AI-compute contracts turn into revenue? Is the stock move -5.8% or -3.8%?
- **Sanken:** how did the stock react on Nov 12? Is the full-year ¥1.4bn operating profit credible after the H1 loss?
- **Mitsubishi Materials:** what is the official Nov 12 close, and was the dividend revised?
- **Honda:** reconcile the EV-loss figures (¥435.1bn vs ¥484.8bn).
- **Katakura:** what is behind the rally? Check EDINET large-holder filings before the Nov 16 Q3 results.
- **Taekwang:** did the audit committee answer Truston by about Nov 12? What does Truston do next?
- **Network access:** allowing kabutan.jp, nikkei.com, jpx.co.jp/TDnet, dart.fss.or.kr, mof.go.jp and sedaily.com in the environment's network policy would allow primary-source verification.